



Major Market Events FY25 Impact Report



University of Colorado **Boulder**

Major Market Events FY25

MAJOR MARKET RECRUITMENT

The purpose of the Alumni Association hosting regional recruitment events is to reconnect alumni, engage them in volunteer opportunities, and highlight ways to support their alma mater. These events foster community, promote networking, and encourage active involvement in the institution's initiatives, helping to strengthen long-term alumni relationships and increase contributions to the school's growth and success.



388

Total Attendees

8

Events

170

Donors

Attendees Overview



"I loved Cultivar! It was a great event with yummy food and drinks, and it was a great way to network with people!"

Brendan Browne, San Francisco

"This event made me realize that I we need more Watch Party locations, and I would love to host one!"

Derek Stillman, Los Angeles

"Had a great time in Michaels in Los Angeles and it was a great way to give back to those communities affected by the wildfires."

Justine Pregler, Los Angeles



"I hope we have more events that are similar to this meet-up that we had at Michael's!"

Julie McCarty, Los Angeles

"Coming to this event inspired me to volunteer more for things... happy hours, movie nights, boat tours, wine tastings, etc."

Lily Kim, Los Angeles



"This was an awesome event! It makes me want to help out more with beach clean-ups, networking events, and entrepreneurship events."

David Berman, San Diego

"This is the first event of this kind that we've had in Eagle County and we hope to have more, even if it's just once a year."

Randy Lasater, Vail/Eagle County

Events Overview

- **CU IN HOUSTON**
Thursday, February 27th
Walking Stick Brewery
- **CU IN VAIL**
Monday, March 10th
E-Town
- **CU IN SAN DIEGO**
Thursday, Wednesday, March 19th
Mike Hess Brewing
- **CU IN LOS ANGELES**
Saturday, March 22nd
Michael's (Santa Monica)
- **CU IN SAN FRANCISCO**
Thursday, March 27th
Cultivar Wine
- **CU IN WASHINGTON, DC**
Thursday, April 3rd
Astro Beer Hall
- **CU IN NEW YORK CITY**
Thursday, May 22nd
The Liberty NYC
- **CU IN COLORADO SPRINGS**
Wednesday, June 4th
Cerebrus Brewing

Total Attendance

648

Total Registrations

342

Total Attendees (EID)

54

Day of Registrants



Key Findings:

- Vail is one of our important donor markets and we paid close attention to who was registered.
- We do not track the total attendance and we just track the attendance of those who have EIDs in Ascend. There were a lot of individuals who brought +1s to the event who were not CU alumni or affiliates.
- San Francisco's showing was small in comparison to the number of people registered due to a bad storm that hit that day.

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"These events are great to promote just being around fellow Buffs!" - Neil Almy, Vail/Eagle County

Total Attendance

CU IN HOUSTON

Registrations: 48
Registration Capacity Reached: ✗
Total Attended: 40
Attended (EID found): 32

CU IN VAIL

Registrations: 57
Registration Capacity Reached: ✓
Total Attended: 52
Attended (EID found): 44

CU IN SAN DIEGO

Registrations: 98
Registration Capacity Reached: ✗
Total Attended: 70
Attended (EID found): 53

CU IN LOS ANGELES

Registrations: 121
Registration Capacity Reached: ✓
Total Attended: 75
Attended (EID found): 65

CU IN SAN FRANCISCO

Registrations: 100
Registration Capacity Reached: ✓
Total Attended: 40
Attended (EID found): 38

CU IN WASHINGTON, DC

Registrations: 64
Registration Capacity Reached: ✓
Total Attended: 30
Attended (EID found): 45

CU IN NEW YORK CITY

Registrations: 120
Registration Capacity Reached: ✓
Total Attended: 50
Attended (EID found): 38

CU IN CO SPRINGS

Registrations: 40
Registration Capacity Reached: ✗
Total Attended: 31
Attended (EID found): 27

Donor Attendance

We shared these events with the entire Advancement team via the Teams channel, so some donors received personal emails from other staff to make them aware of the event. Below are some staff members that attended the events to steward some of their constituents.

DOs in Attendance

CU in Vail Monday, March 10th	Jazmine Kay Brooks (Arts and Sciences)
CU in San Diego Wednesday, March 19th	Jacob Nguyen (Arts and Sciences)
CU in Los Angeles Saturday, March 22nd	Jacob Nguyen (Arts and Sciences) Abby Dunn (Engineering)

170

Donors Attended

\$4,532,387.10

Lifetime Giving of
Donors in
Attendance



Donor Attendance

Donors who gave \$5-\$999	129
Donors who gave \$1,000-\$4,999	19
Donors who gave \$5,000-\$9,999 • 1 donor from Colorado Springs • 1 donor from Vail • 2 donors from Washington D.C. • 2 donors from Los Angeles • 2 donors from New York/Jersey • 3 donors from Houston • 3 donors from San Francisco	14
Donors who gave \$10,000-\$99,999 • 1 donor from Washington D.C. • 2 donors from Houston • 2 donors from Vail • 3 donors from Los Angeles • 5 donors from Colorado Springs	13
Donors who gave \$100,000-\$999,999 • 1 donor from Washington D.C. • 3 donors from San Diego • 3 donors from Houston	7
Donors who gave \$1,000,000+ • 1 donor from Vail	1

ForeverGold Attendance

Alumni Association staff members sent personal communications to ForeverGold members in each of our major markets, inviting them to the event. The registration process was the same, but we saw an increase in ForeverGold member attendance when there was personal outreach involved.

28

of ForeverGold members
registered

15

of ForeverGold members
attended

Houston Registered: 7 Attended: 2	Vail Registered: 2 Attended: 1
San Diego Registered: 5 Attended: 3	Los Angeles Registered: 3 Attended: 3
San Francisco Registered: 4 Attended: 4	Washington D.C. Registered: 2 Attended: 0
New York City Registered: 2 Attended: 0	Colorado Springs Registered: 3 Attended: 2

Young Alumni Attendance

Young alumni are considered to be anyone who graduated in the last ten years: 2015-2025. Staff members who attended major market events often noted that there were many young alumni in attendance, seeking connection, job opportunities and ways to get involved with their alma mater.

216

of young alumni registered

91

of young alumni attended

Houston Registered: 6 Attended: 4	Vail Registered: 3 Attended: 1
San Diego Registered: 35 Attended: 16	Los Angeles Registered: 36 Attended: 16
San Francisco Registered: 27 Attended: 12	Washington D.C. Registered: 25 Attended: 11
New York City Registered: 70 Attended: 24	Colorado Springs Registered: 14 Attended: 7

Advertisement Overview

We worked with the Marketing Communications team to run social media advertisements on Instagram for the CU in the City campaign. They determined which markets would benefit most from an advertisement and determined that the following had the biggest and most influential demographic: San Diego, Los Angeles, New York City and Colorado Springs. The advertisements were run until they reached the registration capacity, which was different for each space based on the venue.

ADVERTISEMENTS

San Diego

Cost: \$480.44
Advertisement Length:
March 8 - March 18
10 Days

Los Angeles

Cost: \$87.04
Advertisement Length:
March 8 - March 10
2 Days

New York City

Cost: \$117.18
Advertisement Length:
May 6 - May 12
6 Days

Colorado Springs

Cost: \$390.00
Advertisement Length:
May 21 - June 3
14 Days

Total Cost

Total Cost Per Event

The prices for the events vary greatly based on a variety of factors:

- Which city the event is taking place.
 - The cost of living in some cities is higher than in others, therefore the venue rentals and catering and drinks vary.
 - Included in the cost of the event is also the cost of travel and lodging for the staff member that is running the event.
- If it was paired with a pre-existing event.
 - For example, CU in Houston was paired up with an already planned site visit for a future Buffs Bash tailgate, so some of the expenses were not included in the cost of the event and travel that accompanied it.
- How many people registered and attended.



Total Cost

Total costs include:

- Advertisement cost
- Employee travel cost (includes airfare, lodging, transportation, food, etc.)
- Event cost (including venue, food, alcohol, AV, etc.)
- Misc. cost

Event	Employee Travel	Event Cost	Alcohol Cost	Ads	Misc. Costs	Total
CU in Houston	\$0.00	\$700.00	\$150.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	850.00
CU in Vail	\$1,014.78	\$432.51	\$245.19	\$0.00	\$0.00	1,692.48
CU in San Diego	\$750.67	\$1,186.23	\$1,270.65	\$480.44	\$0.00	3,687.99
CU in Los Angeles	\$1,291.52	\$7,252.31	\$1,000.00	\$87.04	\$342.00	9,972.87
CU in San Francisco	\$1,033.86	\$6,370.24	778.24	\$0.00	\$0.00	8,182.34
CU in Washington D.C.	\$412.50	\$1,617.37	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	2,029.87
CU in New York City	\$2,300.00	\$3,071.50	\$600.00	\$117.18	\$0.00	6,088.68
CU in Colorado Springs	\$78.80	\$600.00	\$675.06	\$0.00	\$0.00	1,353.86
Totals:	\$6,882.13	\$21,230.16	\$4,719.14	\$684.66	\$342.00	\$33,858.09

Volunteer Newsletter

Because these events were focused on building interest in volunteerism with the CU Boulder Alumni Association, we decided to incentivize sign-ups to our monthly Volunteer Newsletter by offering a free drink ticket if they decided to do so. If individuals at the event were already subscribed to our monthly Volunteer Newsletter, then they just had to pull up a copy of the most recent newsletter to be eligible for the free drink. The majority of the people who attended the event scanned the QR code and signed up.

174 total new registrants

Houston: 17	Vail: 21
San Diego: 39	Los Angeles: 11
San Francisco: 18	Washington D.C.: 19
New York City: 35	Colorado Springs: 14



Post-Event Survey

With the exception of CU in Houston, all of the other events included a survey that could be filled out at the end of the 10-minute presentation by scanning a QR code or through a post-event thank you email.

- Name/ Email
- Which CU in the City event did you attend?
- What kinds of events are you interested in for your area?
- What support might you need from the Alumni Association?
- Are you interested in hosting/leading an event in your area?
- Any additional feedback?

- **20** people filled out the post event survey

- **50%** of those who filled out the survey had interest in planning/hosting an event.

- **40%** of those who filled out the survey had interest in just attending events



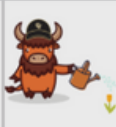
Engagement Continuum

These events were to introduce or re-introduce alumni to their Buff community and the Alumni Association, as well as inform them of all the ways they can get involved both in-person and virtually.

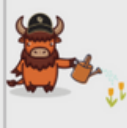
Using our social media advertisements gave us access to alumni that might not have information in our system, meaning that they were either not engaged or have been silent in terms of involvements for a while. We also used email marketing, which targeted those within the city limits of the major market event, plus a 30-mile radius outside of that.

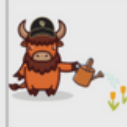
The Engagement Continuum report analyzes entities by Communication, Experiential, Volunteer, and Philanthropic engagement along with service indicators to track progress on a continuum. The numbers shown below for each event show where individuals were prior to the event on the continuum, and where they were after the event, regardless of how they heard about it.

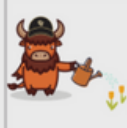
CU in Houston								Total
		1 - Silent	2 - Aware	3 - Curious	4 - Active	5 - Investing	6 - Champion	
BEFORE EVENT	Entity Count	0	10	13	3	6	0	32
	% of Total	0.00%	31.25%	40.63%	9.38%	18.75%	0.00%	100%
AFTER EVENT	Entity Count	0	0	0	25	7	0	32
	% of Total	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	78.13%	21.88%	0.00%	100%

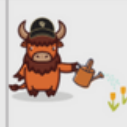
CU in Vail								Total
		1 - Silent	2 - Aware	3 - Curious	4 - Active	5 - Investing	6 - Champion	
BEFORE EVENT	Entity Count	0	16	18	5	4	0	43
	% of Total	0.00%	37.21%	41.86%	11.63%	9.30%	0.00%	100%
AFTER EVENT	Entity Count	0	0	0	38	5	0	43
	% of Total	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	88.37%	11.63%	0.00%	100%

Engagement Continuum

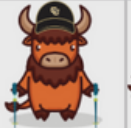
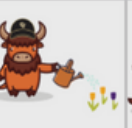
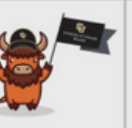
CU in San Diego								Total
		1 - Silent	2 - Aware	3 - Curious	4 - Active	5 - Investing	6 - Champion	
BEFORE EVENT	Entity Count	0	20	14	10	6	0	50
	% of Total	0.00%	40.00%	28.00%	20.00%	12.00%	0.00%	100%
AFTER EVENT	Entity Count	0	0	0	44	6	0	50
	% of Total	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	88.00%	12.00%	0.00%	100%

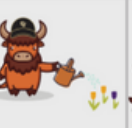
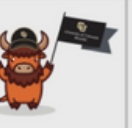
CU in Los Angeles								Total
		1 - Silent	2 - Aware	3 - Curious	4 - Active	5 - Investing	6 - Champion	
BEFORE EVENT	Entity Count	0	24	17	6	9	3	59
	% of Total	0.00%	40.68%	28.81%	10.17%	15.25%	5.08%	100%
AFTER EVENT	Entity Count	0	0	0	47	9	3	59
	% of Total	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	79.66%	15.25%	5.08%	100%

CU in San Francisco								Total
		1 - Silent	2 - Aware	3 - Curious	4 - Active	5 - Investing	6 - Champion	
BEFORE EVENT	Entity Count	0	13	13	5	3	0	34
	% of Total	0.00%	38.24%	38.24%	14.71%	8.82%	0.00%	100%
AFTER EVENT	Entity Count	0	0	0	31	3	0	34
	% of Total	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	91.18%	8.82%	0.00%	100%

CU in Washington D.C.								Total
		1 - Silent	2 - Aware	3 - Curious	4 - Active	5 - Investing	6 - Champion	
BEFORE EVENT	Entity Count	0	6	3	11	9	3	32
	% of Total	0.00%	18.75%	9.38%	34.38%	28.13%	9.38%	100%
AFTER EVENT	Entity Count	0	0	0	20	9	3	32
	% of Total	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	62.50%	28.13%	9.38%	100%

Engagement Continuum

CU in Colorado Springs								
		1 - Silent	2 - Aware	3 - Curious	4 - Active	5 - Investing	6 - Champion	Total
BEFORE EVENT	Entity Count	0	8	7	4	7	1	27
	% of Total	0.00%	29.63%	25.93%	14.81%	25.93%	3.70%	100%
AFTER EVENT	Entity Count	0	0	0	19	7	1	27
	% of Total	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	70.37%	25.93%	3.70%	100%

CU in New York								
		1 - Silent	2 - Aware	3 - Curious	4 - Active	5 - Investing	6 - Champion	Total
BEFORE EVENT	Entity Count	0	10	7	7	5	0	29
	% of Total	0.00%	34.48%	24.14%	24.14%	17.24%	0.00%	100%
AFTER EVENT	Entity Count	0	10	7	7	5	0	29
	% of Total	0.00%	34.48%	24.14%	24.14%	17.24%	0.00%	100%

